B2 Speaking

Making suggestions and reaching a decision

Work with a partner on a shared task: suggest ideas, respond to theirs and agree on a final choice.

In B2 speaking exams, you often discuss a task with a partner, such as planning an event or choosing the best option. Examiners listen for how well you interact, not only for what you say.

Function	Language
Suggesting	*Why don't we...? How about...? We could always...*
Inviting your partner	*What do you think? Would you agree? Which would you choose?*
Accepting	*That's a great idea. That would work well because...*
Rejecting politely	*I'm not sure about that, because... That might be a bit expensive.*
Deciding	*So, shall we go for...? Let's agree on... Are we both happy with...?*

Keep the ball moving. After every idea, pass the turn back: *...What do you think?* Good interaction is shared, not two monologues.

Common mistakes. *How about to go...?* is wrong: use *How about going...?* And don't agree too quickly; examiners want to hear you compare options before deciding.

Practice

You and a friend are planning a farewell party for a colleague.

1. Suggest having the party at a restaurant.
2. Correct the mistake: How about to invite the whole department?
3. Reject the idea of a surprise party politely, with a reason.
4. Invite your partner's opinion about the date.
5. Bring the discussion to a decision.

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. Why don't we have it at a restaurant?
2. How about inviting the whole department?
3. I'm not sure about a surprise party, because she doesn't really like being the centre of attention.
4. Which day do you think would suit most people?
5. So, shall we go for the Italian restaurant on Thursday evening? Are we both happy with that?